AGES 1–2 · FREE · NO SIGN-UP

Little World: look, point and name together.

For ages 1 to 2, the best learning happens in your lap and around the house. These are short, shared moments to do together, most of them away from the screen.

For grown-ups

The American Academy of Pediatrics advises avoiding solo screen use for children under 18 to 24 months, apart from video chatting. If you use a screen at this age, sit together and talk about what you see.

Keep screen moments to a minute or two. Our Look and Name cards stop after six pictures and suggest something to do off-screen.

Follow your child’s lead. Pointing, babbling and copying sounds all count as joining in.

Nothing here promises faster development. It is simply good, ordinary play that gives you more to talk about.

7 ACTIVITIES

Things to do together

Each one has a clear purpose, a way to play, and words to use.

FIRST WORDS

Look and Name cards

On-screen, together · About 2 min

What it builds: Hear and connect everyday words to pictures: colors, animals and familiar things.

You need

- A phone or tablet, on your lap together

How to play

1. Open the cards and hold the screen where you can both see it.
2. Point to the picture and name it slowly: “A duck!”
3. Tap the card to hear the word and the sound, then wait for your child to look, point or babble.
4. After six cards, put the screen away and find one of the things for real.

Things to say

“Where is the duck?”

“What does the cow say? Moo!”

“Your ball is red too.”

Take it further

Find one thing from the cards in your home and give it to your child to hold.

COLORS

One-color treasure basket

Off-screen · About 10 min

What it builds: Notice that different things can share a color, while hearing its name many times.

You need

- A shallow basket or box
- 4 to 6 safe household things of one color (too big to swallow)

How to play

1. Fill the basket with things that are all red: a cup, a sock, a block, a ball.
2. Let your child take things out and put them back.
3. Name each one with its color: "A red sock."
4. Next week, try a different color.

Things to say

"Red cup. Red ball."

"Can you give me the red one?"

"Oh, it goes back in the basket!"

Take it further

On a walk, stop and point to anything red you see.

ANIMALS AND SOUNDS

Animal sounds game

Off-screen · About 5 min

What it builds: Copy sounds and link them to animals: an early step in speech and listening.

You need

- A picture book with animals, or toy animals

How to play

1. Show one animal at a time and make its sound.
2. Pause, smile and wait. Many children try the sound themselves.
3. Make the sound again, a little louder or softer, and see if they copy.

Things to say

"The dog says woof woof."

"Can you say baa like the sheep?"

"Quack! Where did the duck go?"

Take it further

Sing "Old MacDonald Had a Farm" and pause before each sound.

EVERYDAY WORDS

Naming walk around the house

Off-screen · About 5 min

What it builds: Build vocabulary by hearing the names of real, touchable things.

You need

- Nothing, just your home

How to play

1. Carry your child around one room.
2. Stop at five things and name them, letting your child touch each one.
3. Repeat the same walk on other days. Familiar words stick.

Things to say

“Door. Knock knock!”

“This is the light. On… off.”

“Soft blanket.”

Take it further

Add an action word: “open the door”, “turn on the light”.

SHAPES AND MATCHING

Posting box

Off-screen · About 10 min

What it builds: Practice matching an object to a space, hand control and cause and effect.

You need

- A cardboard box with a circle hole cut in the lid
- Large lids or blocks that fit (too big to swallow)

How to play

1. Show your child how a lid drops through the hole.
2. Let them try. Turn the lid to help if they need it.
3. Open the box together and find everything again.

Things to say

“In it goes!”

“Where did it go?”

“Round, like a circle.”

Take it further

Add a second, square hole once circles are easy.

SONGS AND RHYMES

Lap rhymes

Off-screen · About 5 min

What it builds: Hear the rhythm and repeated sounds of language, which later help with reading.

You need

- Your voice

How to play

1. Sit your child on your lap, facing you.
2. Say "Row, row, row your boat" or "Pat-a-cake", rocking or clapping along.
3. Repeat it. Young children love the same rhyme many times.

Things to say

"Again? Row, row, row…"

"Clap, clap, clap!"

"Where are your hands?"

Take it further

Stop just before the last word of a line and let your child fill the gap with a sound or movement.

STORYTELLING

Point and say storytime

Off-screen · About 5 min

What it builds: Enjoy books together and learn that pictures have names.

You need

- A sturdy board book

How to play

1. Let your child turn the pages, even out of order.
2. Point to one thing per page and name it.
3. Follow what they point at and talk about that instead.

Things to say

"Look, a bear! Like Red Teddy."

"What's that?"

"The bear is sleeping. Shh."

Take it further

Make a small photo book of family members and name each person.

> These activities relate to the Head Start Early Learning Outcomes Framework domains of Language and Communication, Cognition, Perceptual, Motor and

> Physical Development and Social and Emotional Development. That is our own mapping, not an official review or endorsement.